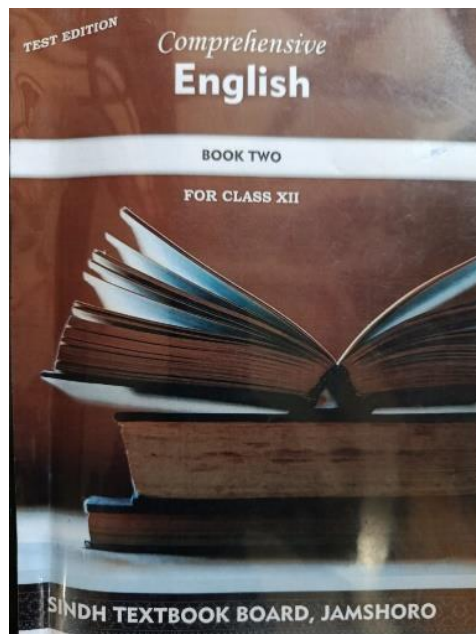


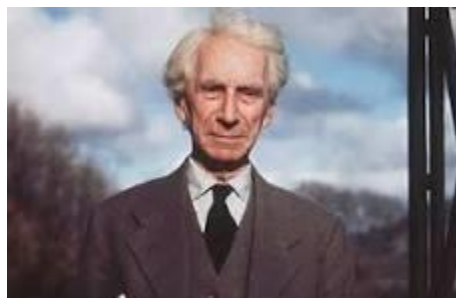
English
Book Two
For the class XII



Conquest of Happiness

By

Bertrand Russell



Bertrand Russell at a glance

Name	Bertrand Russel
Born & died	1872 – 1970
Place of birth	England
Profession	Mathematician, Philosopher and Essayist
Literary period	Modernism and Postmodernism
Notable works	Principia Mathematica, Problems of philosophy, History of Western Philosophy, Conquest of Happiness etc.
Awards/Distinction	Nobel Prize in Literature (1950)
Main theme	True happiness grows from meaningful, constructive work and broad, friendly interests pursued for their own sake rather than for recognition.

Short Question-Answers

Q-1 According to the author, why do scientists often experience deep satisfaction in their work?

Ans- According to the author, scientists often experience deep satisfaction because their works fully engage their abilities and give them a strong sense of purpose. They see their efforts contributing to the progress of knowledge and to society at large, even when the public does not fully understand their results. Science is continually advancing and valued by the world, which reinforces their feeling that their work is meaningful. This combination of skill, purpose, and lasting contribution brings them deep happiness.

Q-2 How does the element of constructiveness bring happiness in the work?

Ans- The element of constructiveness brings happiness because it allows a person to create something lasting and meaningful rather than merely destroying or criticizing. Work that builds and leads from one achievement to another provides a continuous sense of progress and purpose. Such constructive effort nurtures hope, creativity, and inner satisfaction. In contrast, destructive

attitudes often lead to bitterness and hatred. Engaging in constructive work not only deepens personal fulfillment but also helps overcome negative emotions by focusing the mind on growth and positive contribution.

Q-3 What role do hobbies play in the author's broader view of a happy life? What is your hobby?

Ans- According to the author, hobbies play a vital role in a happy life by providing pure enjoyment independent of success, recognition, or pressure. They offer relaxation, balance, and comfort, especially when professional work becomes difficult or stressful. Hobbies reopen simple joys often dismissed in adulthood and help people remain content, sociable, and mentally refreshed. By engaging in harmless pleasures like art, music, or gardening, individuals broaden their interests and reduce emotional strain.

As a student of high school, my "hobby" is exploring ideas through language, reading, analyzing, and creatively responding to texts to help others think more clearly and deeply.

Q-4 If you are to apply the author's idea to your own life, what change would you consider making in your daily routine or mind-set?

Ans- If I were to apply the author's idea to my own life, I would focus on broadening my interests and approaching both people and tasks with a more friendly and constructive mind-set. Instead of measuring daily activities by recognition or immediate results, I would value the quiet satisfaction of meaningful effort. I would also make time for simple hobbies that bring joy without pressure, and try to replace irritation or negativity with curiosity and engagement. Such changes would help create balance, reduce stress, and make everyday life more fulfilling and peaceful.

Q. No-5- What kind of interest in persons causes happiness and what causes unhappiness?

Ans- According to the author, happiness is caused by a friendly and sympathetic interest in other people. When individuals approach others with warmth, curiosity, and goodwill, they become pleasant companions and build positive relationships, which naturally increases happiness. Such an attitude encourages understanding and emotional balance. In contrast, unhappiness arises from a hostile or critical interest in people, marked by suspicion, hatred, or constant fault-finding. This negative outlook isolates individuals and consumes their emotional energy. By choosing friendliness over hostility in human relationships, a person creates harmony within and around themselves.

Q. No-6 Why interest in impersonal things is necessary for the happiness of human beings?

Ans- Interest in impersonal things is necessary because it allows people to step away from personal worries and emotional tensions. By engaging sincerely with subjects like history, science, or nature, individuals can forget their troubles for a time and regain mental calm and balance. Such interests provide a refreshing escape and restore inner stability. When people return from this mental journey, they are better equipped to face their problems with clarity and composure, making impersonal interests an important source of quiet and temporary happiness.

Q. No-7 In your opinion, is happiness more dependent on interest attitude or external circumstances? Explain.

Ans- In my opinion, happiness depends more on one's attitude of interest than on external circumstances. External conditions may influence comfort, but lasting happiness comes from how a person responds to life. A friendly, curious, and constructive attitude enables individuals to find meaning in work, people, and even difficulties. Those who cultivate broad interests and positive engagement can remain content despite limitations, whereas people with favorable circumstances but a negative outlook often remain dissatisfied. Thus, inner attitude plays a stronger and more lasting role in happiness than outward situations.

Below are clear meanings and common synonyms for each word / phrase, written in simple, exam-friendly language:

Admiration

Meaning: A feeling of respect and approval.

Synonyms: Respect, appreciation, esteem

Adulthood

Meaning: The stage of life when a person is fully grown.

Synonyms: Maturity, grown-up life

Affection

Meaning: A feeling of love or fondness.

Synonyms: Love, warmth, tenderness

Archaeologist

Meaning: A person who studies ancient remains and civilizations.

Synonyms: Historian, antiquarian

Artistic

Meaning: Related to art or creativity.

Synonyms: Creative, imaginative

Astronomy

Meaning: The scientific study of stars, planets, and space.

Synonyms: Space science, celestial study

At large

Meaning: As a whole; generally; not confined.

Synonyms: In general, widespread

Blight

Meaning: A disease or condition that causes damage or decay.

Synonyms: Disease, ruin

Companion

Meaning: A person who keeps company with another.

Synonyms: Friend, associate

Conquest

Meaning: The act of gaining control by force or effort.

Synonyms: Victory, triumph

Content

Meaning: Satisfied and at peace.

Synonyms: Happy, pleased

Contribute

Meaning: To give or add something useful.

Synonyms: Donate, provide

Craving

Meaning: A strong desire for something.

Synonyms: Longing, urge

Distinguished

Meaning: Well-known and respected for achievements.

Synonyms: Eminent, notable

Encounter

Meaning: To meet unexpectedly.

Synonyms: Meet, face

Fads

Meaning: Short-lived popular trends.

Synonyms: Craze, fashion

Fascination

Meaning: A strong attraction or interest.

Synonyms: Captivation, enchantment

Fulfilling

Meaning: Giving satisfaction or meaning.

Synonyms: Rewarding, satisfying

Geologist

Meaning: A scientist who studies the Earth's structure and rocks.

Synonyms: Earth scientist

Hatred

Meaning: Intense dislike or anger.

Synonyms: Hostility, bitterness

Hostile

Meaning: Unfriendly or aggressive.

Synonyms: Unkind, antagonistic

Influence

Meaning: The power to affect others.

Synonyms: Impact, effect

Intense

Meaning: Very strong or extreme.

Synonyms: Powerful, severe

Latter

Meaning: The second of two mentioned things.

Synonyms: Second, later

Overcome

Meaning: To successfully deal with a difficulty.

Synonyms: Defeat, conquer

Passionate

Meaning: Showing strong emotion or enthusiasm.

Synonyms: Enthusiastic, intense

Possession

Meaning: Something owned by someone.

Synonyms: Property, belonging

Possessive

Meaning: Wanting to control or own something closely.

Synonyms: Jealous, controlling

Recognize

Meaning: To identify or accept as true or important.

Synonyms: Acknowledge, realize

Significance

Meaning: Importance or meaning.

Synonyms: Importance, value

So long

Meaning: For such a long time / goodbye (context-based).

Synonyms: Farewell, goodbye

Straightforward

Meaning: Simple and easy to understand.

Synonyms: Clear, direct

Thrill

Meaning: A sudden feeling of excitement.

Synonyms: Excitement, delight

Unlike

Meaning: Different from.

Synonyms: Different, dissimilar

Unusual

Meaning: Not common or ordinary.

Synonyms: Rare, strange

Widespread

Meaning: Found over a large area.

Synonyms: Extensive, common

15 MCQs based on the essay “Conquest of Happiness”:

1. According to the author, which group is often found to be the happiest among educated people?

- A. Artists
- B. Politicians
- C. Scientists
- D. Business leaders

2. Scientists find joy in their work mainly because it:

- A. Brings them wealth
- B. Earns public praise
- C. Fully engages their abilities
- D. Requires little effort

3. The author suggests that happiness in work depends largely on:

- A. Fame and recognition

- B. Financial rewards
- C. Emotional detachment
- D. Meaningful engagement

4. Why can even obscure or specialized work bring happiness?

- A. It guarantees success
- B. It attracts admiration
- C. It offers enjoyment in practice itself
- D. It leads to promotion

5. The story of the man writing on rose blight illustrates:

- A. The value of physical fitness
- B. The importance of ambition
- C. Happiness through devoted interest
- D. The need for recognition

6. What gives work greater power to produce happiness than skill alone?

- A. Competition
- B. Constructiveness
- C. Difficulty
- D. Speed

7. Constructive work is fulfilling because it:

- A. Ends all effort
- B. Destroys old ideas
- C. Creates lasting results
- D. Brings instant rewards

8. According to the author, people who enjoy destruction usually:

- A. Achieve quick success
- B. Feel deeper satisfaction
- C. Experience lasting happiness
- D. Struggle to feel joy

9. What helps overcome hatred more effectively, according to the text?

- A. Argument
- B. Isolation
- C. Meaningful work
- D. Entertainment

10. Hobbies are valuable because they:

- A. Increase social status
- B. Provide pure enjoyment
- C. Prove intelligence
- D. Impress others

11. The author criticizes adults for believing that simple pleasures are:

- A. Time-consuming
- B. Financially costly
- C. Emotionally risky
- D. Beneath their dignity

12. Why do people with harmless pleasures make good companions?

- A. They are competitive
- B. They seek attention
- C. They are content in themselves
- D. They demand admiration

13. What does the author mean by “friendly interest in things”?

- A. Emotional attachment to objects
- B. Practical use of objects
- C. Curious and calm engagement
- D. Financial investment

14. Interest in impersonal things helps people mainly by:

- A. Increasing income
- B. Avoiding responsibility
- C. Escaping temporarily from worries
- D. Gaining social approval

15. According to the author, the secret of happiness lies in:

- A. Limiting desires
- B. Avoiding people
- C. Broad interests and friendly responses
- D. Achieving final goals

Answer Key with Justifications

1. C — Scientists

The author explicitly states that among highly educated people, scientists are often the happiest.

2. C — Fully engages their abilities

Scientists find satisfaction because their work uses their talents completely and meaningfully.

3. D — Meaningful engagement

Happiness comes from being deeply engaged in work that feels purposeful, not from rewards or fame.

4. C — It offers enjoyment in practice itself

The text stresses happiness in work comes from enjoying the practice, even without recognition.

5. C — Happiness through devoted interest

The rose blight example shows how dedication to a specialized interest can sustain happiness.

6. B — Constructiveness

The author says constructiveness contributes more to happiness than skill alone.

7. C — Creates lasting results

Constructive work produces something that remains after the work is finished.

8. D — Struggle to feel joy

The text explains that destructive attitudes consume people with hatred, making joy difficult.

9. C — Meaningful work

Engaging in constructive, meaningful work is described as a powerful way to overcome hatred.

10. B — Provide pure enjoyment

Hobbies give pleasure for their own sake, without pressure or external rewards.

11. D — Beneath their dignity

Adults wrongly assume simple pleasures are unsuitable for mature or sophisticated people.

12. C — They are content in themselves

Contentment makes such people pleasant companions, increasing happiness for all.

13. C — Curious and calm engagement

“Friendly interest” refers to a non-hostile, thoughtful curiosity toward impersonal things.

14. C — Escaping temporarily from worries

Interest in impersonal subjects allows mental relief and emotional balance.

15. C — Broad interests and friendly responses

The author concludes that happiness comes from wide interests and a friendly, non-hostile attitude.

Essay

The True Source of Happiness

OR

How Meaningful Work Brings Happiness

OR

Finding Happiness in Work and Interests

OR

The Conquest of Happiness

OR

Happiness Through Purpose and Positivity

OR

Why Constructive Living Leads to Happiness

Brainstorming:

- 1. Misconceptions about Happiness***
- 2. Meaningful Work as a Source of Happiness***
- 3. Joy in Skill and Dedication***
- 4. Constructive Work and Positive Energy***
- 5. Role of Hobbies in Happiness***
- 6. Broad and Friendly Interests***
- 7. Conclusion / Central Idea***

- *True happiness comes from:*

Meaningful work

Constructive effort

Healthy hobbies

Broad interests

Positive attitude

Happiness is often misunderstood as something that comes from wealth, fame, or comfort. true happiness depends more on meaningful work, constructive effort, and a positive attitude toward life. Scientists are often among the happiest people because their work fully uses their abilities and gives them a sense of purpose. They feel satisfied because they know their work contributes to society, even when others do not fully understand it.

Happiness in work is not limited to famous people or great achievements. Any person who develops a skill and enjoys practicing it for its own sake can find deep satisfaction. An example of a man who devoted his life to studying rose blight shows that happiness can come from quiet dedication rather than public recognition. Enjoyment in work grows when a person values the process more than praise.

Another important source of happiness is constructive work. Creating something lasting brings more joy than destroying or criticizing. Work that leads from one achievement to another gives continuous satisfaction. Constructive effort also helps reduce negative emotions like hatred, because it directs energy toward building rather than harming.

Hobbies also play an important role in a happy life. Simple activities such as cooking, music, gardening, or collecting provide relaxation and joy. Although adults often think such pleasures are childish, the author argues that all harmless joys are valuable. Hobbies help people stay balanced and content.

The importance of having a friendly interest in people and even in impersonal things like history, science, or nature. Such interests allow individuals to forget their worries for a while and return to life with calmness

and clarity. In conclusion, happiness comes from meaningful work, constructive effort, broad interests, and a friendly attitude toward life.

“Happiness belongs to those who engage with the world constructively and respond to it with goodwill.”

